

Extraordinary General Meeting
St Columbkille's Pastoral Council

St Columbkille's Hall

June 25th 2015 7pm

Apologies Bob McNamara, Mairead Brown

Present Fr Pat, Miriam McKernan, Irene Galt, Kathy Thompson, Deacon Bill, Fr Ghislaine, Patsy Beveridge, Hannah Weir, Martin Beveridge, Tom Armstrong, Maureen Smith, Charlie and Joan Donnelly, Isabel McCormick, Marie Tedeschi, Mary Tollen, Ed Tollen, Monica Tonner, Ai-ling Anderson,. Donald Anderson, Fr John Sweeneny, Charles Coyle, Paul McNeill, Ed McGuigan, Donald Campbell

This exceptional General Meeting was called by Fr Pat regarding Phase 2 of the church restoration works.

Fr Pat led us in prayer to open the meeting.

Fr Pat outlined housekeeping issues to do with our move from the church to the hall.

The church will close after evening Mass on 29th June, St Peter and St Paul.

Donald Anderson drew a plan for use of the hall as our church during phase 1. This plan will be used for phase 2.

Arranging furniture in the hall to set up for Mass and for the Sacristy will be done at 4pm Sunday 28th June. Able bodied persons are asked to attend.

The Tabernacle, vestments, candles, flower stands, hymn books and Mass readers will be moved after 7pm Mass Monday 29th June. Able bodied persons are asked to attend.

During the period in the hall, there will be 10am Mass and no 1pm Mass on weekdays.

Two all day weddings are planned. On these two Saturday, Saturday vigil Mass will be upstairs. These dates will be notified to permit those with mobility needs to make plans to attend a different Mass.

The food bank will continue without interruption, alongside 10am Mass.

Ed McGuigan presented the existing plans for phase 2.

Funds are available to support a revision of the original phase 2 plan. These funds are from the parish, from Viridor, and a loan repayable of £120,000 from Diocese of Motherwell. The total sum is less than the ambitions for original phase 2 demanded.

Flemings Builders, the architects and the quantity surveyor were thanked for their patience as multiple revisions have been made to plans over the course of 2 years. Many contractors have pegged their original quotes for which we are grateful. Electrical engineering has become much more costly in the two years. Final tenders are awaited. By then, the Building group will know what work we can afford. The Building Group will inform the parish of the final plans in September/ October 2015.

A final payment for phase 1 of approximately £15.000 is due. Phase 1 has been completed well under budget.

Fr Pat, Ed, Paul McNeill, Guy Logan met with Bishop Toal. A grant of £120.00 is made available to the parish.

Bob McNamara and Paul McNeill obtained for us from the National Churches Trust a grant for upgrading the toilet facilities. They are congratulated. Thank you.

There is a plan to issue a list of works which parish members may support as individuals, for example a new light, a new light fitting.

The second collection for the building fund will continue until Christmas to support this phase 2 works.

Ed concluded by thanking Hamish McBeth especially for his attention to detail, permitting cost savings, and preparing for an immediate start on phase 2 once we vacate the church.

Miriam thanks the Building Committee warmly on behalf of the parish. They have work steadfastly for years, suffering reverses and disappointments and challenges. They have delivered a weather proof roof to prevent further damage, and we look forward to their work bearing more fruit in phase 2.

Discussion took place.

The ambition for a sound system and a lighting system was aired. It was agreed that these were most desirable, and it is hoped that some of the work can be accomplished in phase 2. It may be necessary to fund these works separately.

Similarly, the reconditioning and restoration of the organ will be a separate project.

Projection facilities to aid people with hearing or visual impairment is desirable to include all of our parish, including those in advancing years. Gain, this may require a separate piece of work and funding.

Reconditioning of all internal woodwork was discussed. It seems that the original stain will remain, in keeping with the original design. The benches will be stained to match existing woodwork in the church. The expense of altering the stain on existing woodwork would not be met within budget.

Fr Pat sought a commitment to repay the debt to the diocese.

It was proposed that the parish repays £25.000 per annum. The meeting felt this sum would be readily reappraised from the second collections for the Parish Debt.

Proposed Fr Pat

Seconded Martin B

Unanimously accepted.

Fr Pat thanked all anonymous donors, and St Columbkille's Smarties collection of £1200.

Deacon Bill advertised the Parish Day at Carfin July 29th

Fr Pat asked for a Fabric Committee to be established to be responsible for maintenance of the buildings.

The Meeting closed with parayer.